Extended reading

Read the article and leaflet from a magazine about tea.

Tea: China's gift to the world

Tea is currently the world's most popular drink, only after water. However, there was a time when tea was known only to the Chinese. So, how did tea originate in China? And how did it get to conquer the world to the extent that people often describe something they really like as their "cup of tea"?

While we know that tea drinking started in China, its true origin remains something of a mystery. Legend has it that about 5,000 years ago, Shennong came across tea when dried leaves blew into a pot of boiling water. Following his discovery, tea was used as medicine, included in meals and later offered as a refreshing drink to officials and noblemen. Eventually, it became a common drink enjoyed and embraced by all Chinese people.

Over the years, as tea drinking became an important part of China's rich culture, the love of tea inspired many people to write about it. The great Tang poet Du Fu described his tea-drinking experience in poetic language, "On the high place the setting sun does shine. In the spring breeze, I sip my tea, sweet and fine." Lu Yu, a tea master, wrote *The Classic of Tea*, which remains the earliest and most famous detailed study on tea in the world, covering everything anyone could possibly want to know about Chinese tea.

It is then not surprising that the beauty of tea was eventually revealed to a wider world. The Tang and Song Dynasties needed strong horses from Xizang, where tea enjoyed enormous popularity. As a result, the Tea Horse Road was born. Porters carrying back-breaking loads of tea bricks made their way through dangerous snow-covered mountain passes in the most terrible weather conditions, to trade Sichuan and Yunnan tea for horses. Over time, the gift of tea was further delivered to Western Asia. Meanwhile, different sea routes also helped spread tea to other parts of the world. As early as the Tang Dynasty, Japanese monks came to study in China and took with them tea seeds and tea-making customs when returning to Japan. Around the 1600s, tea was shipped to Europe from China by Portuguese and Dutch sea traders.

The well-known writer Lin Yutang summed up the power of tea when he said, "There is something in the nature of tea that leads us into a world of quiet contemplation of life." Tea drinking is not just about refreshing the mind and body but also about appreciating the harmony between man and nature.

From hillside to teacup

Growing tea

Tea plants grow best in warm, humid regions with well-drained soil. Consequently, they grow well on steep hillsides where heavy rain can easily drain away.

China boasts many tea-growing areas, which can be divided into four distinct regions. Among them the south-west tea-growing region is the oldest while the region south of the Yangtze River produces the most tea in China.

[*Subheading 1*] ______________

Tea bushes are grown in rows and cut to a height of about one metre, to allow tea pickers to easily harvest tea leaves. It takes up to five years for a tea bush to come to maturity, at which time the bud and top leaves are picked every few days. The tea-picking season may start as early as February and extend until late November.

[*Subheading 2*] ______________

The process of turning tea leaves into the tea we love to drink is both complicated and highly technical. There are commonly between two and seven procedures involved in the processing of the fresh tea leaves. Any addition or exclusion of these stages may result in a different type of tea: green, yellow, white, black or oolong tea. Actually, all these different types of tea can be made from a single tea plant.

[*Subheading 3*] ______________

Tea can be enjoyed in many different ways. For example, the English drink their tea with milk, the Japanese enjoy powdered green tea, and in Morocco, mint tea is preferred. Tea drinking has also become part of many countries' culture. The English have their "afternoon tea", and in China, rightfully regarded as the birthplace of tea, tea drinking can be both a common daily practice and a near ceremonial experience.

A *Write a summary of the magazine article. Use the following ideas to help you.*

- The history of tea
- The spread of tea
- People's love of tea
- The power of tea

B *What might be appropriate subheadings for the different sections of the leaflet? Write them down in the blanks.*

C *Coffee is also a drink that enjoys popularity around the world. How is it similar to and different from tea?*

Project

Making a proposal for an agricultural field trip

A *As a class, discuss farming in your local area. Then in groups, decide on one agricultural field trip you can propose.*

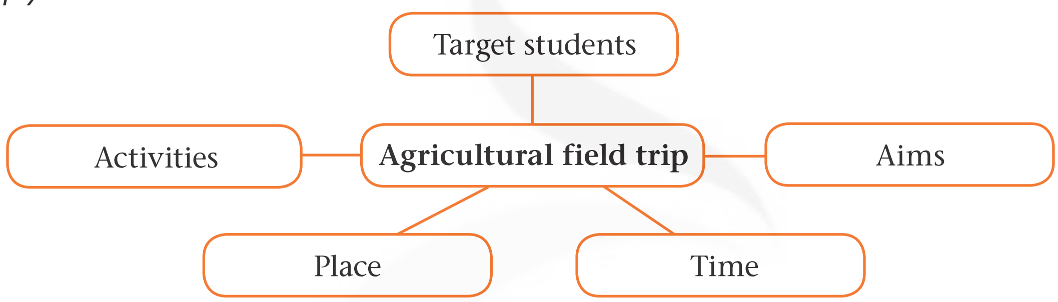
Tip

Doing background research on an agricultural field trip

When you do background research, it is a good idea to break the topic down into smaller subtopics. For example, you can look at different aspects of local farming:

- what crops are grown in your local area;
- what their growing cycles are like;
- what activities need to be done at each stage.

B *As a group, brainstorm ideas for your agricultural field trip. Use the chart below to help you.*



C *As a group, put together your information to write your proposal. Use the example below to help you. Then present your proposal to the rest of the class.*

Proposal for an agricultural field trip

Target students: All Senior Two students

Aims:
- To help students develop a love of agricultural work
- To inform them of the latest developments in China's rural areas
- To increase their awareness that food is valuable and should not be wasted

Time: May

Place: Oriental Corn Farm

Activities:

Day 1 (Observing and learning)

- Going on a tour of the corn farm
- Learning about corn farming
- Getting to know recent innovations in corn cultivation
- Interviewing the farmers about their work

Day 2 (Practice in groups)

- Applying fertilizer in the fields
- Watering the corn
- Weeding
- Controlling pests

Day 3 (Experience sharing)

Reporting on what they have learnt on the agricultural field trip and how they feel about it

Assessment

Complete the following learning journal to assess your performance. Then work in groups and exchange your learning journal with your partners.

Learning journal

In this unit I learnt ____

____

____.

I was most interested in ____

____

____.

I did well in ____

____

____.

However, there is something I need to improve on: ___________________________

____

____.

In order to make more progress, I will ______________________________________

____

____.

* Assess your learning of vocabulary and grammar by doing language practice on pages 62–63.

Further study

Smart farming uses technologies like the IoT and AI to create an efficient farm management system. This newly emerging farming method has a bright future as it improves farming processes to increase food production. Surf the Internet to discover more about smart farming.

Known as the "Father of Hybrid Rice", Yuan Longping successfully developed a high-yielding rice crop. Widely grown in China and many other countries, it has fed billions of people across the world. Find and read a biography about Yuan Longping to learn more about this remarkable man.

UNIT 3

On the move

Transportation is the center of the world! It is the glue of our daily lives. When it goes well, we don't see it. When it goes wrong, it negatively colors our day ...
—Robin Chase

In this unit, you are going to:

- read an automobile magazine article about self-driving cars;
- write a speech transcript to promote road safety;
- read a feature article about China's high-speed rail network;
- make a leaflet about a futuristic means of transport.

Welcome to the unit

Means of transport have evolved significantly over the course of human history. Look at the pictures below and discuss the following questions in pairs.


Animal power


____


____


Petrol


____

1 What energy is used to power the different means of transport in the pictures above? Fill in the blanks.

2 What other criteria can you think of to categorize different means of transport?

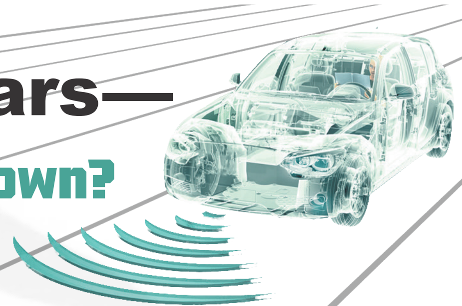
3 What do you think could be the trend for future transport?

Reading

New technologies from the digital era are set to transform our means of transport. The automobile magazine article below describes a new trend in transport: self-driving cars. Before you read the article, think about the following questions:

- What technological advances in transport do you know about?
- What do you know about self-driving cars?

Self-driving cars—destination known?



Mr Zhang casually glances at the empty driver's seat and says, "Destination Grand Hotel. Family mode. Start." The car responds immediately, easing smoothly into the busy traffic and avoiding obstacles on the road. Inside the car, the family have chosen their entertainment from a pop-up display panel, ready for the journey ahead. This imagined scene provides a likely future reality for self-driving cars, also known as autonomous vehicles.

However, before this evolution in transport becomes a revolution, it must be fully understood how self-driving cars work. Put simply, self-driving cars must "see" and "behave" appropriately to be safe on the road. They do this through various hardware and deep-learning artificial intelligence (AI). Cameras as well as sensors like radar and lidar capture a variety of data from the external environment. Once the data is sent to the AI system, the "brain" of the self-driving car, it is analysed and put together like a puzzle so that the car can "see" its surroundings and determine its position. Meanwhile, the AI system identifies patterns from the data and learns from them. An action plan is then created to instruct the car how to "behave" in real time: stay in the lane, move into another one, speed up or slow down. Next, the necessary mechanical controls, such as the accelerator and brakes, are activated by the AI system, allowing the car to move in line with the action plan.

This may sound perfect in theory, but in reality technological barriers exist in the development of self-driving cars. The perception system is an example of this. Road traffic in the real world is so complicated that unfamiliar or unexpected conditions may occur at any time. Since it is unreasonable for the database to include every possible object in every possible condition ahead of time, the system might not recognize everything on the road. In one tragic real-life case, a self-driving car's perception system failed to identify a white truck against the bright, sunlit sky. It assumed that there was no obstacle in its path and did not activate the brakes, causing the death of the driver in the self-driving car. Accidents like this pose the question of how self-driving cars can better learn and improve their behaviours on the road to ensure safe journeys.

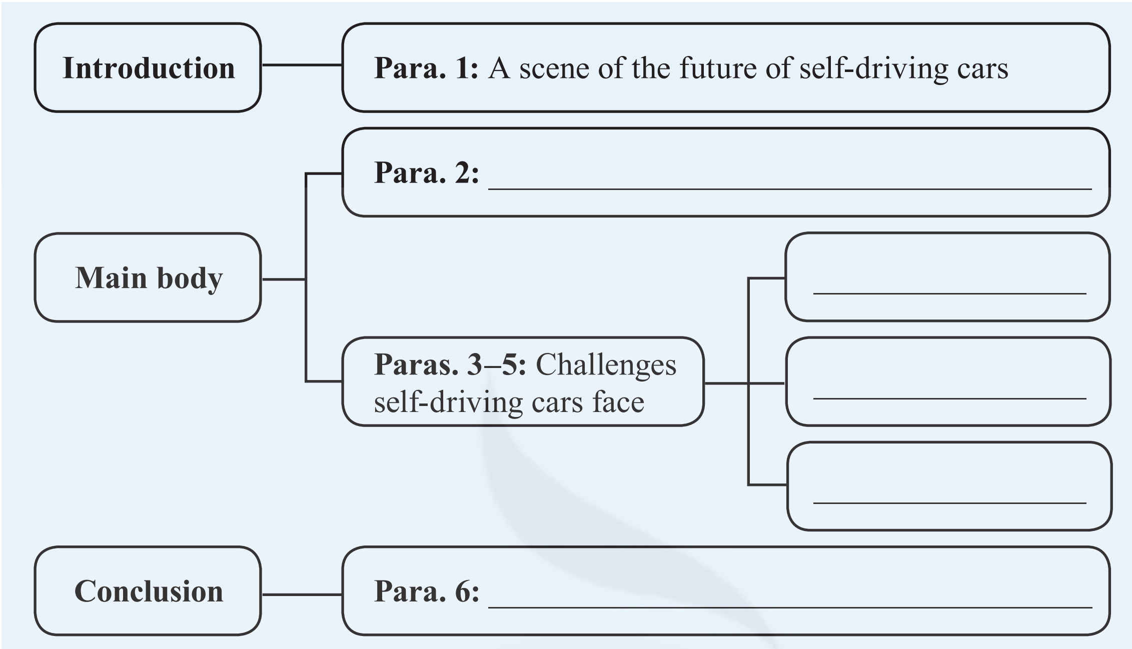
Another aspect that needs careful consideration is the ethical responses self-driving cars would make in specific circumstances. The Trolley Problem is often used to discuss difficult ethical choices they may face. For example, should those in the self-driving car always be protected first even if it means endangering the lives of pedestrians? Should the self-driving car hit a single pedestrian to avoid crashing into a group of pedestrians? And would it make a different decision if the pedestrian were a child or a senior citizen? The moral dilemma that comes with how to ethically program self-driving cars has yet to be resolved.

Besides such ethical concerns, the legal situations the autonomous vehicle industry is likely to be confronted with have fuelled heated debates. In this emerging industry, manufacturing and programming standards are not yet uniform. Moreover, the quality and safety of the technology used in self-driving cars is still being challenged. This could lead to extraordinary cases like who should be held responsible when self-driving cars are involved in accidents—should it be the driver, the software programmer or the manufacturer? Manufacturing and programming standards first have to be agreed upon to make it possible for law courts to decide who is at fault when things go wrong. As advances in autonomous vehicle design and technology are in progress, the final agreement on laws and regulations governing this industry remains to be seen.

There can be little doubt that, despite all the challenges, self-driving cars will form a big part of our future. The question is, what is next? Some argue that self-driving cars should be allowed to operate without human control, while others are more cautious and believe that human operation, even if limited, is still necessary. Only time will reveal its true path. While the journey ahead is not without obstacles, the eventual destination is bound to be another milestone for humankind's amazing vision and inventiveness.

A Understanding the text

A1 *Read the automobile magazine article and complete the chart below with the main idea of each paragraph.*



A2 *Read the automobile magazine article again and answer the following questions.*

1 How do self-driving cars "see"?

______

2 Why is a self-driving car's perception system likely to fail?

______

3 What ethical choices may self-driving cars face in relation to the Trolley Problem?

______

4 What must be done first before law courts can decide who is at fault when self-driving cars are involved in accidents?

______

5 What are the two possible future paths of self-driving cars?

______

A3 *In pairs, discuss the following questions.*

1 The author uses an imagined scene to introduce the topic of self-driving cars. What do you think of this introduction? How would you introduce the topic if you were to write an article about self-driving cars?

2 The author mentions some barriers self-driving cars face. How do you think these barriers might be overcome?

3 When predicting the future, the author talks about two possible paths of self-driving cars. Which path do you think self-driving cars will take? Why?

B Building your language

B1 *The passage below is about the use of big data in transport. Complete the passage with the correct forms of the words and phrases in the box below.*

revolution	dilemma	identify	in line with
fuel	perception	be bound to	be confronted with

Big data technology has started a (1) ________________ in transport systems, which impacts ways people get around. Devices such as traffic cameras and underground fare gates collect information about drivers' and passengers' behaviours, including driving habits in various weather conditions and route choices at different times of day. The data is then analysed by algorithms and exchanged among devices and systems connected through the Internet of Things. Consequently, decisions can be made (2) ________________ this mass of data.

The availability of big data provides considerable advantages for individuals who (3) ________________ the task of planning their travels. They can compare travel information according to their needs like fare, time and walking distance before deciding on which option suits them best. Similarly, drivers can use apps to easily access real-time traffic and parking information, thus avoiding traffic jams and seeking out available parking spaces.

On the other hand, big data technology improves the management of public transport systems. Many countries face the (4) ________________ between public transport coverage and ridership, as an expanded transport network would mean fewer passengers on a single vehicle. Now these countries can use information collected from GPS and passenger ticket data to (5) ________________ patterns in passengers' route choices and supply bus routes that meet their demands. Bus services are then tailored to offer shorter waiting times and faster routes. Enhancements like this present convenient options to passengers, changing public (6) ________________ of transport systems. Furthermore, they offer sustainable long-term solutions which (7) ________________ benefit a country's economy and environment.

However, the use of big data (8) ________________ public concern about the protection of personal information. For example, many apps require access to users' locations without them knowing how the data would actually be used. Therefore, measures must be taken to ensure users' private information is kept secure.

B2 *The automobile magazine article uses some phrases to predict probable future outcomes. Find them in the article and revise the paragraph below using these phrases.*

> New technologies will give rise to amazing new transport options in the future. One option we may be able to see in China is smart roads. With the move towards smart technologies, IoT-enabled road sensors and electric recharging lanes may be used, which are able to quickly connect to and communicate with smart cars. This could greatly reduce the high number of serious road accidents. Furthermore, electric lanes that can recharge vehicles will certainly help reduce air pollution.

Grammar and composition

Subjunctive mood (I): unreal conditionals

A Exploring the rules

Rachel is reading a blog post about a city's transport system. Find the sentences with unreal conditionals and fill in the table below. The first one has been done for you.

Once a small ancient town, our city has mushroomed over the past decades, becoming one of the largest in our country. This rapid growth has, not surprisingly, resulted in increased traffic. Luckily, city planners have tackled the problem to keep everything running efficiently. Today our effective transport system caters for everyone's needs and we are very proud of it.

The city's road network is spread like a web, and buses are the most convenient transport option. Citizens can get to work and school and visit their favourite city hotspots quickly and comfortably. Another popular transport option is the underground, which was brought into use ten years ago. If the city hadn't built the underground system, getting around wouldn't be so convenient. Now the city has plans for more underground lines, which is excellent!

Our city has one airport, which has served travellers faithfully for years. If this airport hadn't been constructed, our city wouldn't have attracted so many tourists. However, the increased demand for travelling, both domestically and internationally, means the air transport facilities need to be upgraded. A proposal for a new bigger international airport is under review, creating much excitement. If a bigger airport were built, the traveller experience should be greatly improved.

When visitors come to our city, they can enjoy a wide range of transport options. I recommend they try our river ferries. A big part of our city's history, ferry transport offers many scenic journeys. If they lived in our city, they could use the ferry from time to time. With so many easy ways to get around, everyone can expect their travels in our city to be full of interesting experiences!

Present	
Past	
Future	
Mixed	If the city hadn't built the underground system, getting around wouldn't be so convenient.

Working out the rules

- To talk about an (1) ________________ (imaginary/actual) situation, we use unreal conditionals.
- We form unreal conditionals in different ways.

  Present: *If … were/did …, … would/should/could do …*

  Past: *If …* (2) ________________ *…, … would/should/could have done …*

  (3) ________________**:** *If … were/did/should do/were to do …, … would/should/could do …*
- We use mixed conditionals when the time of the main clause is different from that of the *if*-clause.

☛ Grammar and composition notes → pages 93–94

B Applying the rules

B1 *There is one mistake in each of the sentences below. Circle the mistakes and correct them in the blanks.*

1 You would not be so upset if you are not caught in this traffic jam.

____

2 If this train moved faster, we are arriving at our destination sooner.

____

3 If cars were invented in ancient times, what would our ancestors' lives have been like?

____

4 If my car were a flying car, I will never get stuck in traffic.

____

5 The flight might not be cancelled if the weather had been better.

____

B2 *Rachel is writing a competition entry on the topic "Improving our city's traffic". Complete it with the correct clauses in the box below. There is one clause you do NOT need to use. Write the letters in the blanks.*

The long line of traffic at the green light moves slowly, as usual. Shaking your head in frustration, you wonder if you will make it to work on time. With today's smart technologies, this situation should become a thing of the past. (1) ________________, I would suggest installing the Adaptive Traffic Control System (ATCS), a smart traffic management system.

(2) ________________, its machine learning technology would improve our city's traffic flow enormously. The ATCS employs cameras and sensors to continually collect data about vehicles approaching traffic lights, and then it analyses vehicle movement patterns. With this information, it can adjust red and green light timing cycles to keep vehicles moving smoothly according to real-time traffic conditions. For example, at peak travel times, green lights that last longer can ensure a more fluid stream of traffic. (3) ________________, drivers might be stuck in traffic jams more frequently.

(4) ________________, our city's air pollution would have been sharply reduced. As the ATCS reduces the constant "stop-go" action, which contributes to carbon emissions, it helps lower the amount of pollutants. In the end, installing the system could provide a highly effective solution to both traffic jams and air pollution.

a If the ATCS had been installed in the past
b If traditional traffic systems should be replaced with the ATCS
c If I were asked to introduce one smart technology to improve our city's traffic
d If they were not forced to sit at an unnecessary red light
e If traffic light timing cycles were not adaptive

B3 *In pairs, talk about ways to improve your hometown's traffic using unreal conditionals. The beginning of the conversation has been given.*

A: *My dad drove me to school today and the traffic was so bad that I was late for class!*

B: *You know, if our city had improved the traffic flow at peak times, you might not have been late.*

A: *I agree. Any ideas?*

…

Integrated skills

Dealing with traffic accidents

A *Alice is going to give a speech for Traffic Safety Day. She has found an article on the website of the Transport Department. Read the article below and answer the following questions.*

The facts speak for themselves: an estimated 1.3 million people die in road traffic crashes globally every year, while driver error is responsible for more than 90 per cent of them. Therefore, drivers should be reminded about the common causes of road accidents and the measures to prevent them.

One common cause is drivers not paying attention. Drivers tend to lose concentration when they are checking their phones, or even adjusting controls in the vehicle. Feeling tired or getting annoyed in traffic can prove equally distracting for drivers. Changes on the road can happen in the blink of an eye, and drivers must be ready to react immediately and correctly. Therefore, drivers' failure to pay full attention to road conditions can have disastrous consequences.

Similarly, driving over the speed limit or after consuming alcohol increases the likelihood of traffic accidents. Speeding reduces the time allowed for the driver to respond to something unexpected on the road, while increasing the distance and time needed to stop the vehicle. The result could be a minor traffic accident, or in the worst case, an overturned vehicle and even loss of life. Drink-driving is another major risk factor for road accidents. With alcohol, the driver's abilities to operate a vehicle safely are significantly affected. The driver would struggle to stay alert, recognize dangers and respond appropriately.

To minimize the risk of road accidents, it is essential to practise safe driving. This requires that drivers avoid all high-risk behaviours. By doing so, we can greatly decrease the frequency and severity of traffic accidents, and ultimately make the difference between life and death to everyone on our roads.

1 What facts are given to draw the reader's attention to traffic accidents caused by drivers?

____

2 What are the leading causes of traffic accidents drivers are responsible for?

____

B *Alice is listening to a talk about traffic accidents by a traffic official. Listen and finish the exercises below.*

B1 Listen to the talk and choose the best answer. Circle the letters of the correct options.

1 What is the purpose of the talk?
- **a** To explain why e-bikers are growing rapidly.
- **b** To warn about disobeying traffic laws.
- **c** To help keep our roads safer.

2 What can be a cause of traffic accidents?
- **a** Using the phone.
- **b** Not wearing helmets.
- **c** Navigating around busy city streets.

3 Why should pedestrians and e-bike riders be extra careful?
- **a** They often go at high speed.
- **b** They cause more road accidents than other road users.
- **c** They are more exposed to injury.

B2 Listen to the talk again and complete the notes below.

Causes of traffic accidents

Causes common to pedestrians and e-bike riders

- Not paying attention to the street or (1) ________________
  - ➢ Speaking on the phone
  - ➢ Staring at (2) ________________
- Not following (3) ________________
  - ➢ Using lanes that are meant for other road users
  - ➢ Ignoring the red light
  - ➢ Dashing across the road at (4) ________________

Causes typical of e-bike riders

- Turning without (5) ________________
- Loading e-bikes with other people or (6) ________________

C *In pairs, discuss traffic accidents and road safety. Use the following questions and expressions to help you.*

- What is the current state of road safety?
- What are the common causes of traffic accidents?
- What solutions would you suggest for drivers, pedestrians and e-bike riders?

Expressions

Suggesting solutions

A good solution could be ...
An alternative way to ... is ...
The problem could be solved if ...
It is advisable/wise to improve the situation by ...
What about ... to fix the problem?

D *Write a speech transcript for Traffic Safety Day calling on people to promote road safety. Use your ideas from part C and the information in parts A and B to help you. Check and improve your writing after you finish it.*

Current state of road safety

Causes of traffic accidents

Suggested solutions

Title: ______________________________

Extended reading

Read the feature article about China's high-speed rail network.

Racing towards the future: a look at China's high-speed rail network

In the distance, a white bullet-nosed train is thundering down the track. It grows larger by the second until it eventually slows and glides past the lines of waiting passengers. As it eases to a stop, the train doors open with a hiss and the passengers board with eager anticipation. Then its doors close and the train departs exactly on time, its progress barely noticed as it quickly and silently gathers speed. Seated comfortably in the well-equipped, spacious carriages, the passengers know that their journey ahead will be both effortless and relaxing.

Such scenes of contented passengers being swiftly transported to their destinations are repeated many times a day all over China, as far as the high-speed rail (HSR) network extends. Since 2008, the HSR network has transported over 10 billion passengers, setting a world record. There are now more than 7,000 high-speed trains running daily, some reaching speeds of up to 350 kilometres per hour, the fastest in the world of train transport. The HSR network has an overall length of around 40,000 kilometres in operation, covering almost all provincial-level regions of China. It not only greatly enhances the national railway's efficiency, but also serves as the engine that keeps the country's economic lifeblood flowing.

However, China's high-speed rail network was not built overnight. The HSR project began in the 1990s and it has grown enormously since then. A key milestone was the release of the HSR network blueprint in 2004, when the plan for "four vertical and four horizontal" corridors was put forward. Twelve years later, it was upgraded to "eight vertical and eight horizontal" corridors. Today, China boasts the world's longest and most extensively used HSR network, and is rightly considered the world leader in HSR construction.

This enormous success is inseparable from the visionary leadership of the Communist Party of China as well as the great wisdom of the Chinese people. With innovation and perseverance, they have climbed over hurdles and passed one milestone after another. The Beijing-Shanghai line, the world's longest line built in one stage, has the fastest high-speed trains, reducing the travel time between Beijing and Shanghai from 14 hours to less than 5 hours. The Harbin-Dalian line, the first high-cold high-speed railway in the world, can operate at 350 kilometres per hour in temperatures as low as –40°C. The Beijing-Zhangjiakou line, the world's first smart high-speed railway, has set the standard for HSR automatic driving. The Fuxing Electric Multiple Unit (EMU), which made its debut in 2017, is another remarkable accomplishment that demonstrates technical skill in HSR design and construction. Developed and manufactured totally by China, the EMU train boasts modernized features, elegant designs and advanced technologies that are superior to those of previous models. It is built with a longer lifespan and an energy-saving design to reduce air resistance. All these achievements showcase the wholehearted devotion of engineers, the tireless effort of railway workers, and the strong support of all the Chinese people.

It is no surprise then that China's HSR network has grabbed the attention of the whole world. In the spirit of international cooperation, China has generously exported its technology and skills to many countries, and helped them construct high-speed railway lines. This is in line with the Belt and Road Initiative, which aims to revive the ancient Silk Road and connect the countries along the route. The World Bank has praised China's HSR success and its positive impacts which go well beyond the railway sector to include urban development, regional economic growth and reductions in greenhouse gas emissions. The HSR network has become a new symbol of China, and "China Standard" has become the "World Standard".

In the past, the HSR's path was filled with obstacles and achievements. Racing towards the future, China's HSR network will continue to grow, improving the lives of its people and strengthening unity among them. Now, it is shining a bright light on the track ahead to even greater success. So, sit back and enjoy the ride!

A *What characteristics of China's high-speed trains can you infer from the first paragraph? Use details to support your idea.*

B *How can you introduce China's HSR network to a foreign friend? You can use information from the article or other sources.*

C *How do you think high-speed rail is changing people's lives? What sorts of activities or lifestyles are possible now that did not exist in the past?*

Project

Making a leaflet about a futuristic means of transport

A *As a class, discuss futuristic means of transport. You can use the ideas below or think of other ideas. Then in groups, choose one futuristic means of transport to research.*

flying hoverboards	personal rocket ships	jetpacks
teleportation devices	flying cars	hyperloop trains

B *As a group, research and discuss your chosen means of transport. Use the ideas below to help you.*

- Basic information
- Advantages
- Challenges related to its development

C *As a group, put together your information to make a leaflet. Use the example below to help you. Then present your leaflet to the rest of the class.*

Flying cars: flying high and reaching for the sky!

A traffic jam is almost every driver's nightmare. Therefore, it is not surprising to see why the idea of turning cars into flying machines has been popular for years, as seen in a lot of science fiction novels and films. Now this fantasy may become a reality in the near future.

Basic information

- A flying car is a type of personal vehicle that provides transport by both land and air.
- With technological advancements, a few models of flying cars have already completed test flights.

Advantages

- Reducing road traffic jams
- Travelling across greater distances much faster than ordinary vehicles
- Freeing up space on the ground for parks and other public spaces

Challenges

- Building an engine that is powerful enough to lift and fly the car for long periods
- Creating a strong lightweight body so that the flying car can be used in any type of weather and climate
- Designing sky "roads" to manage the flow of traffic in the air
- Making new traffic regulations in the sky

Assessment

Complete the following learning journal to assess your performance. Then work in groups and exchange your learning journal with your partners.

Learning journal

In this unit I learnt ____

____

____.

I was most interested in ____

____

____.

I did well in ____

____

____.

However, there is something I need to improve on: ______________________

____

____.

In order to make more progress, I will ______________________________

____

____.

* Assess your learning of vocabulary and grammar by doing language practice on pages 67–68.

Further study

The future of transport is full of exciting possibilities. New transport technologies and innovations are bound to introduce faster, safer and more environmentally friendly travel options. Watch a documentary about the future of transport to find out what possibilities await us.

China has built the world's largest high-speed rail (HSR) network. This widespread network provides Chinese citizens with an efficient and affordable way to travel around the country. Read a book to find out more about China's HSR network.